



Not the best value for money. But they sound good.

NEED V/S WANT – TECH EDITION

As we mentioned before, don't fall for something flashy, and instead focus on what it is you need. Temporary gratification is great, which is why so many of us fall for it, but tough times call for us to be tougher, especially on ourselves.

First, let's talk about smartphones. A small crack on the screen might be irritating, but a dent in the pocket at the wrong time can be unbearable!. The difference between the price brackets is falling fast, and this is especially true in the smartphone segment. A good phone below the budget of ₹20,000 tries to incorporate many of the features of phones twice or even thrice that cost. Now of course a phone that costs three times more will have a better overall experience, but is that experience worth the price bump? That's where we come in. Our reviews (found at digit.in) look at finding the performance to value sweet spot. Some of the phones that can be looked at in and around the ₹20,000 segment include Redmi Note 11 T, Realme 9 SE, and iQOO Z3 5G.

For slightly higher budgets, you can consider buying a previous generation smartphone (brand new or used) for a frac-

tion of the price it was just a year ago. That way you get the premium experience and build quality and features, but at a much cheaper price range.

When talking about laptops, as we explained earlier, go for value for money and not peak performance. Getting the latest and greatest hardware is not a wise choice just before a recession. This is especially true as many of us buy our gadgets on EMIs, which means we're paying for them for a year or two. Not wise. Much better to save for two years, have enough to pay for the device outright, and then once the recession seems to be ending, buy it on install-



Is it a need or a want?

ments and keep the saved money as your rainy day fund!

You need to be careful about naming conventions and being up to date with generations, and the like. You don't want to be paying MRP for a product that's last-gen.

Audio devices, especially headphones, are where we spend a lot of money unintentionally. In times that we are going to face soon as we have maintained so far, it would be the best to cheap out a little. Do you really need RGB in your headphones? Focus more on sound quality than flashy extras. Two channel will do fine instead of 7.1 channel headphones. Focus on a product that's known to be more durable, and if you're looking for a specific use case, such as TWS to use while travelling, one with better isolation and noise cancelling will do a far better job than one which is able to more accurately reproduce the 12khz band, but has worse noise cancelling. Know your need, and buy accordingly.

Tablets and consoles are often things many of us buy, only to have them collect dust for weeks on end. If you're one of those people, buying a latest gen console or a tablet is just a waste. The latest gen consoles have already been here for a while and are still selling at MRP or higher because of the shortages. Keep abreast with the news and find out when the new gen is due, it may be wiser to save for those, even if you are a console fanatic. Meanwhile, use screencasting and Bluetooth accessories to play the game on your phone while looking at the TV. You might find this to be a good enough console experience for you. Or not.

Overall, what you need to do is focus on the value for money aspect much more, no matter what the purchase price or category of gadgets. While we at Digit are usually the ones to push budgets higher for everyone, the fact that this is our cover story should hopefully get you to pay attention and be wiser with tech. Set price alerts, search for coupons, or just wait. You can also grab a hold of us on social media to ask for buying advice. Best of luck! 🍀